maybe the difference between biometric and two-factor authentication does not justify the costs.

A data security policy could also define other implementation-driving factors. The principles may define which types of data have to always be encrypted, such as PII or the company's financial data. The constraints may define the lifespan of this data. The standards may define encryption algorithms used. Preparation of the policy details requires a good understanding of the data that's in the possession of the company and its level of sensitivity; the timeline of each data type's business usage and related legal constraints; and finally, the currently implemented standards and how they compare to industry standards.

Discussing the feasibility of proposed policies is a good measure, preventing actors at a high level of governance from operating from an ivory tower. To implement this discussion in your company, you'll need to develop robust mechanisms for a bilateral communication of policymakers with subject-matter experts that include, for example, a transparent and searchable feedback cycle. In addition, to ensure that your governance body can find a balance between policy direction and applicability, you need to include processes of utilizing internal resources or acquiring outside help in your governance setup.

Assigning accountability and responsibility for data

The primary goal of the data governance process is to ensure *accountability* for each bit of the company's data. Therefore, it is the most critical element to keep in mind, independently of which path to data governance you may take.

Similar to nonfunctional requirements, this part of governance requires the know-how of a company's operations and needs to reflect the realities of data use. To achieve clarity in terms of data accountability, you should ask your governance body to answer a set of questions concerning each data asset: